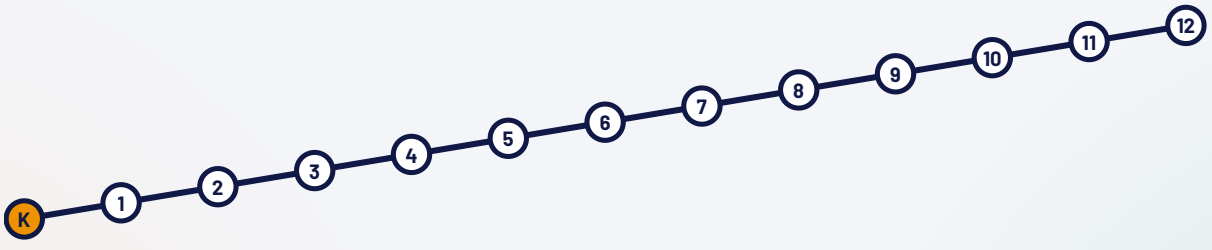
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: Grades 6–8

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12, with questions and options for our part in the story.



These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade (2,709 ratings, completed November 2026), not what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

Contents

1	**Middle school, Grades 6-8** Grades 6 to 8, all four subjects.	**3**
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, and the limits.	**17**

Each part follows the same path: the picture (charts), what the numbers say, what we notice, questions for us, and our part in the story (options for improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). The data behind each item is shown in brackets, and each item links to the matching page of the Vertical Alignment site. About the data (where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use and the limits) is at the back. 20 pages, A4. The bookmarks jump to each part.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

MIDDLE SCHOOL, GRADES 6 TO 8

Middle school, Grades 6-8

In Grades 6-8, teachers reported that 61% of the 479 grade-level ratings (336 standards; each grade rates the same 64 Social Studies standards) are at least introduced, and 20% are taught in depth. ELA is the clear strength at 53%, with Grade 7 ELA at 70%.

20%
taught in depth

61%
at least introduced

39%
not taught

479
grade-level ratings

What you are seeing. Four headline figures for this part: the share taught in depth, at least introduced and not taught, and how many ratings they come from.

What it adds to our story. This is the starting picture for this part. The slides that follow show where these numbers come from and what they might mean for us.

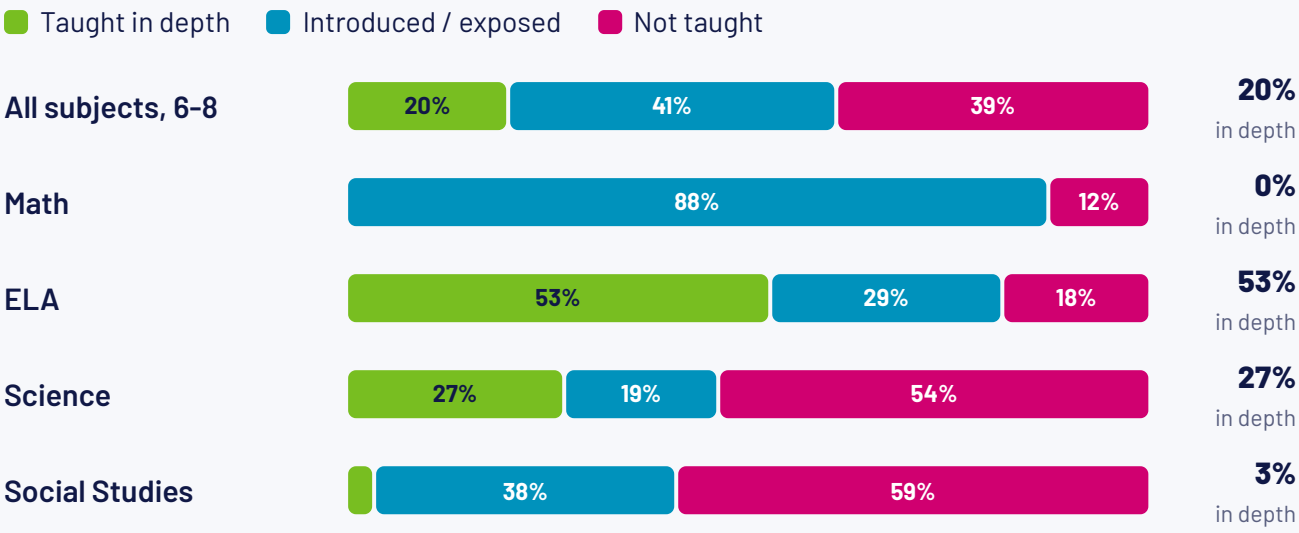
These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

THE PICTURE

At a glance

What you are seeing. Each bar shows all the ratings for one subject: green is taught in depth, blue is introduced, pink is not taught.

What it adds to our story. ELA is the strength of middle school. Math covers almost everything and rated none of its standards in depth.



How to read this: each bar is 100% of the grade-level ratings. Green is taught in depth, blue is introduced or exposed, pink is not taught. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

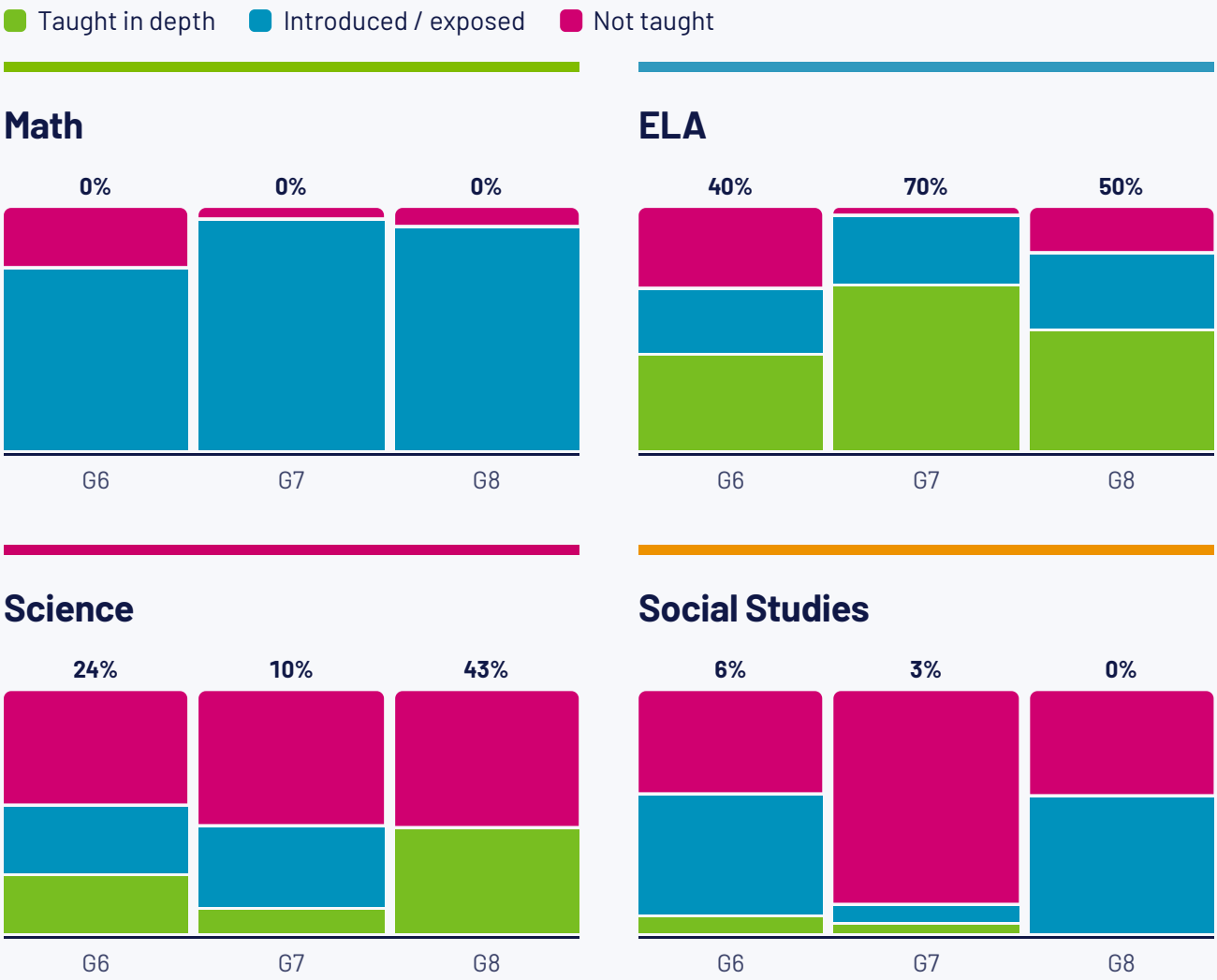
Share in depth	G6	G7	G8	6-8
Math	0%	0%	0%	0%
ELA	40%	70%	50%	53%
Science	24%	10%	43%	27%
Social Studies	6%	3%	0%	3%
All subjects	17%	22%	21%	20%

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column for each grade. The number on top is the share of that grade's standards taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. Each middle school grade has its own mix, and Science seems to give each grade its own discipline.



How to read this: for each subject, one column per grade, with the share taught in depth on top.

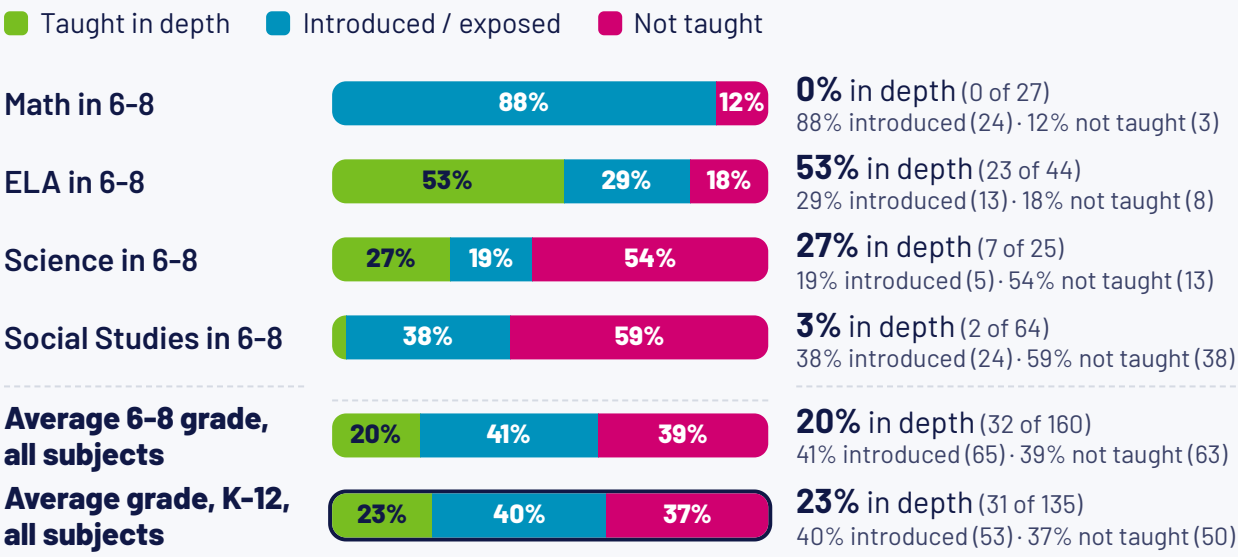
Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

THE PICTURE

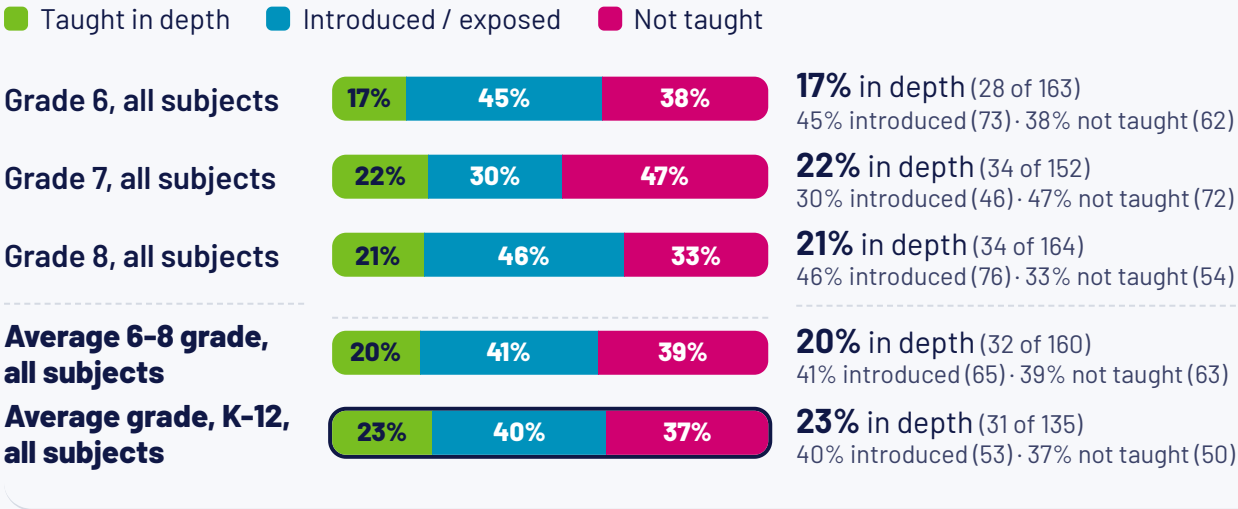
Our curricular capacity

What you are seeing. Each bar is one average grade in a year: 100% of its grade-level standards, split into in depth, introduced and not taught, with the number of standards beside it. Each subject in the band, then the band average and, last, the school average (the average grade K-12, all subjects).

What it adds to our story. A 6-8 grade takes 20% of its grade-level standards to depth in a year (about 32 of 160), introduces 41% (65) and does not teach 39% (63). The average grade K-12, all subjects, takes 23% to depth (about 31 of 135).

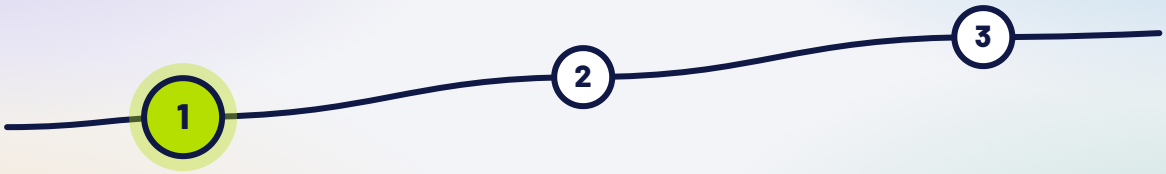


Curricular capacity: what a grade currently takes to depth, introduces and leaves untaught in a year, by its own teams' ratings of its grade-level standards (Wisconsin Common Core for Math and ELA; AERO, NGSS or Wisconsin for Science and Social Studies; not Essential Elements). Not a measure of teaching time, and not a target.



6-8 · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

Section 1: Facts



Facts
YOU ARE HERE

Patterns

Moving forward

SECTION 1 OF 3

Facts

What you are seeing. The main facts from the ratings, in plain numbers. Each one links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

What it adds to our story. Two very different pictures sit side by side here, which makes middle school a good place to compare how teams read the scale.

Bright spots

Where teaching is strongest.

1. **ELA leads.** 53% in depth, 29% introduced, 18% not taught. Writing (59%), Speaking and Listening (58%), Reading (52%) and Language (45%) are all strong. Coverage map ↗
2. **Grade 7 Reading stands out.** 89% of Grade 7 Reading standards are in depth. Coverage map ↗

Gaps

Standards rated not taught by the grade they belong to, or where they were placed.

3. **Social Studies.** 3% in depth, 38% introduced, 59% not taught. Each grade rated the same 64 middle school standards. Coverage map ↗

4. **Progressions.** 12 of the 48 ELA, Math and Science progressions in this band break down on an official link, all in ELA, and 15 are taught at every step (ELA 10, Math 5). In the K-12 view, 3 Social Studies progressions are not taught in any of Grades 6, 7 and 8. Progressions ↗

5. **Hand-overs.** 26 standards taught in depth here build on a K-5 standard rated not taught. 12 high school standards build on a 6-8 standard rated not taught. The 26 rest on suggested links, not official ones. Of the 12, 3 (Grade 9 Math) rest on official Coherence Map links and 9 on suggested links. Each suggested link is worth checking first. Progressions ↗

6. **Standards not taught in any grade they belong to.** 52 in 6-8 (ELA 24, Social Studies 18, Math 10). A further 29 Science standards are rated not taught in the grade where they fit best. Gaps and repetition ↗

Breadth without depth

Standards introduced widely but rarely taken to depth.

7. **Math is met widely.** 88% of Math ratings are at least introduced, second only to high school ELA (92%). Coverage map ↗

8. **Introduced, never in depth.** 159 standards are introduced and never in depth: Math 71, Social Studies 40, ELA 38, Science 10. Gaps and repetition ↗

Anomalies

Results that stand out and are worth a second look.

9. **Science has almost no middle ground in Grade 8.** 43% in depth, 57% not taught, nothing rated introduced. Grade 8 dashboard ↗

10. **Grade 7 Social Studies.** Grade 7 rated 91% of the 64 middle school standards not taught, against 44% in both Grade 6 and Grade 8. Coverage map ↗

11. **Math is almost entirely "introduced".** The three Math teams rated all 81 standards and none in depth, which may reflect a strict reading of "every class"; 71 are introduced (88%) and 10 not taught. Grade 7 is 96% introduced and Grade 8 is 93%. Coverage map ↗

Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

12. **The band in 3 numbers.** 96 ratings in depth (20%), 195 introduced (41%), 188 not taught (39%). Coverage map ↗

13. **Science by grade.** 24% in depth in Grade 6, 10% in Grade 7, 43% in Grade 8. Across the band, 54% of Science ratings are not taught. Coverage map ↗

14. **Priority standards.** 32% of priority ratings are in depth, against 20% for all standards. ELA priorities reach 68% and Science 50%. Math is at 0% and Social Studies at 7%. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

15. **Grade 7 Science priorities.** 2 of 14 Grade 7 Science priority standards are in depth and 6 are not taught. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

16. **Essential Elements.** 29% in depth: ELA 57%, Science 31%, Math 7%, Social Studies 3%. Coverage map ↗



SECTION 2 OF 3

Patterns

What you are seeing. What we notice when we put the facts side by side: rises, dips and comparisons. These are possibilities to talk about, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. Many differences here may come from how courses are scheduled and how strictly "in depth" was read, not from how much is taught.

Trends across the grades

How things rise, fall or alternate from grade to grade.

1. **Life Science is the thinnest Science strand.** 7% in depth and 67% not taught across 27 ratings, between a stronger K-5 (47%) and Grade 11 (50%). Grade 11 dashboard ↗
2. **ELA rises into middle school and dips out of it.** Grade 5 is 18%, Grade 6 is 40%, Grade 7 is 70%, Grade 8 is 50% and Grade 9 is 33%. Coverage map ↗
3. **Math falls into middle school and rises out of it.** Grade 5 is 32%, Grades 6 to 8 are 0%, Grade 9 is 30%. Three Grade 9 Math standards taught in depth build on Grade 6 and Grade 8 standards (equations, roots) rated not taught. Progressions ↗

Handoffs

What passes between grades and between schools.

4. **Math coverage is a strength to build on.** Ratios and Proportional Relationships and Functions have no standard rated not taught. Five of the 9 Math progressions are taught at every step (at least introduced in each grade); none is yet in depth. Most of the ground is covered; the open question is depth. Progressions ↗
5. **Grade 6 is where the most progression findings land.** 29 findings, the most of any grade K-12. They are ELA 17, Social Studies 7, Science 4 and Math 1, many of them Grade 6 standards that build on K-5 standards rated not taught. Progressions ↗

Language and literacy

Where language and literacy are taught, and how.

6. **Science and Social Studies carry literacy too.** Middle school ELA is strong (53% in depth), and academic vocabulary and writing may also be taught in Science and Social Studies lessons, which the ELA ratings would not show. Coverage map ↗

How we rated

Where the ratings may reflect how the scale was read.

7. **Middle school Math rated almost everything introduced.** Almost every Math standard (71 of 81 ratings) is rated the same way, "introduced", across the three grades. A pattern that uniform is unusual. One possibility is a strict reading of "ALL classes, all or nothing". The teams can tell us. Coverage map ↗

8. **Grade 7 Social Studies rated most standards not taught.** Grades 6 and 8 rate about half the standards introduced. Grade 7 rates 91% not taught. This may reflect how courses are scheduled across the three years. Coverage map ↗

Choices and capacity

What a grade can carry in a year, and what we choose.

9. **Science looks organised by discipline.** Grade 6 carries Earth and Space (67% in depth). Grade 8 carries Physical Science (62%) and Engineering (100%). Life Science sits mainly in Grade 7 (15%). Standards that fit a grade but belong to a discipline it does not teach are rated not taught. Coverage map ↗

10. **Priority standards are deepest where teaching is already deep.** ELA priority standards are in depth 68% of the time, above ELA as a whole (53%). In Math, priority standards are rated the same as everything else (0% in depth); in Social Studies they are close (7% against 3%). Priority and power (Audit) ↗

11. **Some Science standards fall outside the discipline their grade teaches.** 29 Science standards are rated not taught in the grade where they fit best, mostly because that grade teaches a different discipline. The open question is how and when those standards are taught. Gaps and repetition ↗

12. **Capacity shows what a middle school grade carries in a year.** A middle school grade takes about 32 standards to depth across its four subjects (about 8 per subject), introduces about 65 and does not teach about 63, out of about 160 rated, the most standards per grade of any band. By subject, per grade: ELA about 23 in depth of 44 rated, Science 7 of 25, Social Studies 2 of 64, and Math none of 27 (24 introduced). As shares of each subject's ratings: ELA 53% in depth, 29% introduced, 18% not taught; Math 0% in depth, 88% introduced, 12% not taught; Science 27% in depth, 19% introduced, 54% not taught; Social Studies 3% in depth, 38% introduced, 59% not taught. Capacity here means what a grade currently reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. It is not a target and not a judgement. Coverage map ↗

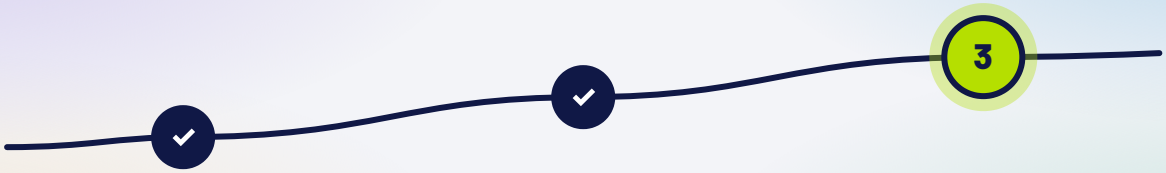
Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

13. **Two subjects, two very different pictures.** ELA has the highest share in depth of any band and subject pairing in the school (53%). Math, which introduces almost everything, rated none of its standards in depth. Both are taught to the same students, so the difference is worth exploring together. Coverage map ↗

14. **No middle school grade takes Inquiry, History or Political Science to depth.** Inquiry Practices, History and Political Science have no standard in depth in any middle school grade (0 of 99 ratings). Coverage map ↗

Section 3: Moving forward



Facts · Patterns · **Moving forward** YOU ARE HERE

SECTION 3 OF 3

Moving forward

What you are seeing. Questions for teams to talk about. Each one shows the data that prompted it, and links to where that figure appears on this page.

What it adds to our story. Middle school is the bridge between two schools, so these questions are about what students bring in and carry on.

Improving the curriculum

What to teach, deepen, place or leave out.

1. **Where should Life Science reach depth between K-5 and Grade 11?**
   (Data: Life Science is 47% in depth in K-5, 7% in 6-8 with 67% not taught, and 50% in Grade 11) see Pattern 1
   Coverage map ↗

2. **How might inquiry skills in Social Studies be taught through the reading, writing and discussion that ELA already does well?**
   (Data: 0 of 30 Social Studies Inquiry ratings in depth; ELA Writing 59% and Speaking and Listening 58%) see Fact 1
   Coverage map ↗

3. **When a grade teaches mainly one Science discipline, how are the standards from the other disciplines in that grade taught?**
   (Data: 29 Science standards not taught in the grade where they fit; Earth and Space 67% in depth in Grade 6, Physical Science 62% in Grade 8) see Pattern 9
   Gaps and repetition ↗

4. **If Math covers 88% of its standards, which 10 would we choose to take to depth first?**
   (Data: 88% at least introduced; 71 standards introduced and never in depth) see Fact 11
   Gaps and repetition ↗

5 **With about 160 standards per grade, which could middle school agree to leave out on purpose, and which would it introduce only?**

(Data: 6-8 mix: 20% in depth, 41% introduced, 39% not taught; about 63 standards per grade not taught) see Fact 12

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels

Grades and teams comparing and planning together.

6 **What is the ELA team doing in Grade 7 that brings so much to depth, and what could travel to other subjects?**

(Data: Grade 7 ELA is 70% in depth; Reading 89%) see Fact 2

Coverage map ↗

7 **Could the Grade 5, middle school and Grade 9 Math teams rate 5 standards together and compare?**

(Data: Math in depth is 32% in Grade 5, 0% in Grades 6 to 8, and 30% in Grade 9) see Pattern 3

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

What the next grade or school relies on.

8 **Which K-5 standards does Grade 6 most rely on, and has Grade 6 told Grade 5?**

(Data: 26 standards in depth in 6-8 build on a K-5 standard rated not taught; Grade 6 has 29 progression findings, the most of any grade) see Fact 5

Progressions ↗

9 **What does Grade 9 need students to bring in Math, and what do Grades 6 to 8 need from Grade 5?**

(Data: 3 Grade 9 Math standards in depth build on Grade 6 and Grade 8 standards rated not taught, all on official links)

Progressions ↗

How we rate and plan

How we read the scale and plan our time.

10 **When the Math team rated a standard "introduced", what did they picture, and what would "in depth" need that is not yet in place?**

(Data: 71 of 81 Math ratings are introduced; none rated in depth) see Fact 11

Coverage map ↗

11 How is Social Studies scheduled across Grades 6 to 8, and what would the Grade 7 team like us to know?

(Data: On the same 64 standards, Grade 7 rates 91% not taught; Grades 6 and 8 rate 44%) see Fact 10

Coverage map ↗

12 For 3 middle school standards rated "introduced", what would a common end-of-unit task look like that every class gives?

(Data: 20% of middle school ratings are in depth and 41% introduced; Math is 88% introduced) see Fact 12

Coverage map ↗

13 With about 160 standards per grade, which are essential and which are good to have?

(Data: Grades 6, 7 and 8 rated 163, 152 and 164 grade-level standards; 39% of ratings are not taught) see Fact 12

Coverage map ↗

14 Knowing a middle school grade takes about 32 standards to depth a year out of about 160, which should they be, and which could we agree to introduce or leave out?

(Data: Per grade in 6-8: about 32 in depth, 65 introduced, 63 not taught, out of 160 rated) see Pattern 12

Coverage map ↗

Our part in the story

What you are seeing. Options for what we could do, under four headings, each with the data behind it.

What it adds to our story. This is where findings turn into action: small, shared steps we could take together.

Options to discuss and act on. Pick what fits your team, change it, or add your own.

Improving the curriculum

In middle school Math, we could choose 10 standards to take to depth next year, starting with ratios and expressions.

(Data: 71 of 81 Math ratings are introduced; none rated in depth) **see Fact 11**

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels

We might bring the Grade 5, middle school and Grade 9 Math teams together to rate 5 shared standards.

(Data: Math in depth: Grade 5 32%, Grades 6 to 8 0%, Grade 9 30%) **see Pattern 3**

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

In Science, each grade could plan how it will teach the standards that fall outside its main discipline.

(Data: 29 Science standards not taught in the grade where they fit; Earth and Space 67% in Grade 6, Physical Science 62% in Grade 8) **see Pattern 9**

Gaps and repetition ↗

A concrete action we could take

We might plan one Social Studies inquiry unit with ELA in each middle school grade, using ELA's strength in research and argument.

(Data: 0 of 30 Inquiry ratings in depth; ELA Writing 59% in depth) **see Fact 1**

Coverage map ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

> **These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers.** They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

Where the numbers come from. Every figure is computed from the ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings, last rating 8 November) and checked against the Vertical Alignment reports and findings decks.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between: some classes, or taught briefly (for example, 3 of 5 classes)

Rating	What it means
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Four things to hold in mind while reading.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught across a whole grade. They are not a measure of what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read that more or less strictly, so a low figure can reflect a stricter reading, not less teaching. Where this matters most, the paper says so. Where a team rated none of its standards in depth, we read it as careful use of an all-or-nothing scale, not as an absence of teaching.
- Each team rated its own subject's standards. Much literacy (vocabulary, academic language, speaking, writing, reading non-fiction) is also taught through Science and Social Studies, and that teaching may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of the main grade-level ratings (one standard in one grade). Essential Elements (the alternate standards) are counted apart.

We cannot teach everything equally. No school can take every standard to depth, and that is not the goal. The goal is to choose on purpose: which standards we teach in depth, which we introduce, and which we leave out, and to plan that proportion together across the grades. The ratings show the mix we have now, so we can decide the mix we want.

Curricular capacity. How many standards a grade reports taking to depth, introducing or leaving out in a year, worked out from the ratings (the average for one grade). It is not a target and not a judgement: it describes the mix we report now, so we can decide together how to use it.

Categories. In every part, each section groups its items under the same categories, in the same order, so a team can follow one kind of observation across the whole school, its band and its subject. Facts: Bright spots, Gaps, Breadth without depth, Anomalies and Other notable. Patterns: Trends across the grades, Handoffs, Language and literacy, Essential Elements, How we rated, Choices and capacity, Toward the SAT and Other notable. Moving forward: Improving the curriculum, Working across grade levels, Knowing the bands above and below, and How we rate and plan. A category with nothing in it is left out.

How each part is laid out. Three sections, each opening with a small map that shows where you are: Facts, then Patterns, then Moving forward (questions to ponder, then options for our part in the story: improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). Every pattern carries its figures in the text, and every question ends with the data behind it, in brackets and italics. The questions are invitations, not conclusions. Our strengths are named alongside the places where we might build.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.
- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.

- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Curricular capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught. They do not measure what students know or can do.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.